

G Mark 73

A lean tine electric piano: modelled tines and pickup, no samples, tremolo or auto-pan, up to 32 voices.



Overview

G Mark 73 is a tine electric piano in the spirit of the classic tiny freeware e-piano plug-ins: a handful of controls, a light touch on the CPU, and the sound of a 70s stage piano. Like everything in GFX it uses no samples. Each note is a struck tine, modelled with three decaying resonators: the tine itself, its tonebar, and the bright bell partial of the hammer strike. These are read by a magnetic pickup set slightly off-centre, so soft notes are round and pure and hard notes bark.

One LFO does two jobs, as on the original plug-in: turn MODULATION right for tremolo, left for auto-pan. WIDTH spreads the keyboard across the stereo field, low notes left and high notes right. The sustain pedal (CC64) works.

Reach for it for

- Classic tine electric piano: soul, jazz, ballads
- Suitcase tremolo and wide auto-pan pads
- Barking, driven rock and funk keys
- Bell-like, glassy high tines
- A light e-piano when your session is already heavy

Controls

TINES

DECAY	How long notes ring when held: from about 0.8 s to 15 s at middle C. Low notes ring longer, high notes shorter, as on the real thing.
RELEASE	How quickly a note stops when you let go: the damper, from 40 ms to about 1.3 s.
HARDNESS	The hammer: more bell at the start of each note, more pickup bark on hard hits, and a brighter tone overall. Low settings give a soft, felt-like sound.
TREBLE	A high shelf at 2.5 kHz, -6 to +12 dB.

MODULATION

MODULATION	Turn right for tremolo (the level pulses), left for auto-pan (the sound moves between the speakers). The centre is off. The light blinks with the LFO.
RATE	The LFO's speed, 0.1 to 10 Hz.

PLAYING

VELOCITY	How much key velocity changes the level (hardness always follows velocity).
WIDTH	How far the keys spread across the stereo field: 0% is mono.
VOICES	Polyphony, 8 to 32. When all voices are busy the oldest note is taken, released notes first.

TUNING

FINE	Fine tuning, -50 to +50 cents.
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RANDOM

A random detune on every note, up to 50 cents (4 by default): a little life, or an out-of-tune upright.

MASTER**DRIFT**

See Drift below.

DRIVE

Overdrive: drives the pickup and the output for a broken-up, growling tone.

VOLUME

-24 to +6 dB.

SAT

The GFX band saturation on the output (0% by default).

OFF / CLIP / LIM

The GFX output stage. CLIP (the default) is a soft clipper just under 0 dB; LIM is a look-ahead limiter. The band frequencies, bias and ceiling are in the parameter list.

Meters

Output level, left and right.

The header**PRESETS**

Opens the patch list (or click the display). An asterisk after the patch number means you have changed it.

◀ / ▶

Step through the patches.

MIDI

Blinks on each note.

S / M / L

Panel size: small, medium or large. The panel also scales to fit the plugin window.

?

Opens a pop-up with the design credit, the GFX website address and the address of this manual. Click anywhere to close it.

Drift

DRIFT (0 - 100%, 50% by default) is the universal GFX instrument drift: the pitch and the tone wander slowly, and every new note lands slightly off tune. 50% is the

standard amount, 100% twice that, 0 steady; the wander also speeds up as you turn it up.

Patches

Mark 73	The classic, balanced stage-piano sound.
Bright Stage	Harder hammers, more treble and a touch of drive: cuts through a band.
Mellow Ballad	Soft hammers, long decay, a darker top.
Suitcase Tremolo	Tremolo at a medium rate.
Auto Pan Wide	A wide stereo spread with slow auto-pan.
Bark	Very hard hammers and drive: hard notes growl.
Bell Tines	Hard hammers and lots of treble: glassy, bell-like highs.
Soft Felt	The softest hammers and a dark top: round and quiet.
Drive Amp	Heavy drive with fast tremolo, like a piano through a cranked amp.
Lo-Fi Upright	Short, dark and narrow, with tremolo and more random detune.

Tips

- Play with dynamics: HARDNESS and the pickup respond to velocity, so the tone changes as much as the level.
- For classic tremolo, try MODULATION around +50% with RATE between 4 and 6 Hz.
- Raise VOICES only if you hear notes cut off in long sustained passages; fewer voices use less CPU.
- For an old, characterful instrument, turn RANDOM and DRIFT up together.

File: gfx-g-mark-73.jsfx